

# MEDIEVAL HISTORY

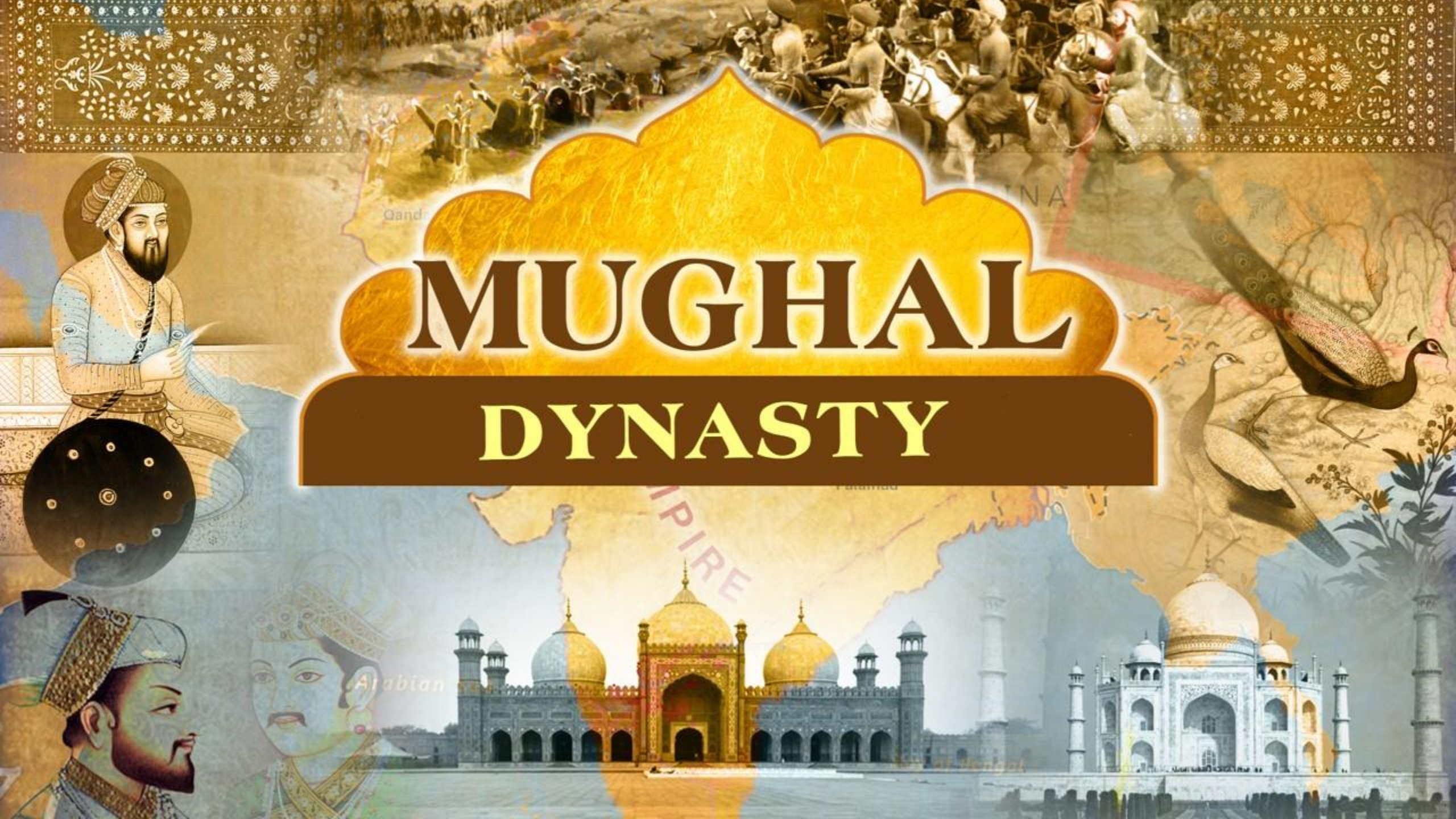


**MODULE - 25**

**MUGHAL DYNASTY**  
**AKBAR – PART 3**







# MUGHAL DYNASTY

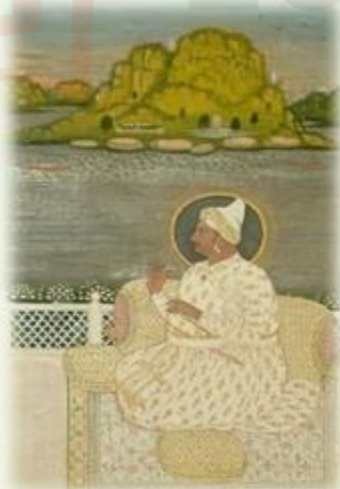


# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)**

## ADMINISTRATIVE SYSTEM UNDER THE AKBAR

### INTRODUCTION



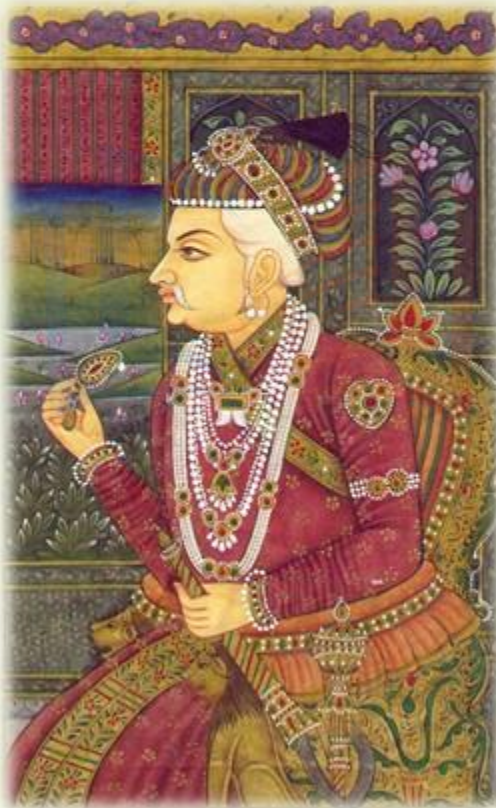
- 1 The Mughals retained many features of the administrative system of the Sultanate and Sher Shah Suri's administration.
- 2 The administration was highly centralised and the territories of the empire were divided into
  - Jagir
  - Khalisa (income went directly to the royal exchequer) and
  - Inam (lands allotted to learned and religious men).

# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## CENTRAL ADMINISTRATION

### THE EMPEROR



- 1 The Emperor was the supreme head of the administration and controlled all military and judicial powers.
- 2 All officers in Mughal administration owed their power and position to the Emperor.
- 3 The Emperor had authority to appoint, promote, and remove officials at his pleasure.



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## CENTRAL ADMINISTRATION

### WAZIR



- 1 The position of the wazir was revived under the Mughals under whom various heads of departments functioned.
- 2 He was the principal link between the ruler and the administration.
- 3 Babur's and Humayun's wazir enjoyed great powers.
- 4 The period during Bairam Khan , saw the rise of the Wakil-wazir with unlimited powers.
- 5 Akbar reorganised the central machinery of administration on the basis of
  - division of power between various departments
  - checks and balances.



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## CENTRAL ADMINISTRATION

### WAZIR



- 6 ■ In his determination to curb the powers of the wazir, he took away the financial powers from him, which was a big jolt to the wazir's power.
  - While the post of wakil was not abolished,
- 7 This post was given to important nobles from time to time, but they played little part in administration.
- 8 Thus, the head of the revenue department continued to be wazir, but he was no longer the principal adviser to the ruler, but an expert in revenue affairs having title of *diwan* or *diwan-i-ala*.
- 9 *The Diwan* used to inspect all transaction and payments in all departments and supervised the provincial diwans.



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)**

## CENTRAL ADMINISTRATION

### MIR BAKSHI



- 1 The head of the military administration was *Mir Bakshi* who was also considered as head of the nobility.
- 2 Recommendations for appointment to mansabs or for promotions were made to the emperor after duly endorsed by him only.
- 3 Once the emperor accepted the recommendation, it was sent to the diwan for confirmation and for assigning a jagir to the appointee.
- 4 The Mir Bakshi was also the head of the intelligence and information agencies of the empire. **Barids** (intelligence officers) were posted to all the parts of the empire.
- 5 Their reports were presented to the emperor at the court through Mir Bakshi.
- 6 He kept a strict watch over proper maintenance of the sanctioned size of armed contingents and war equipage by the mansabdars.



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## CENTRAL ADMINISTRATION

### MIR SAMAN



- 1 The *Mir Saman* was the officer in-charge of the royal household and royal karkhanas.
- 2 Functions of Mir Saman:
  1. He was responsible for all kinds of purchases, manufacturing of different articles for the use, and their storage for the royal household.
  2. The maintenance of etiquette at the court, the control of the royal body guard, etc., were all under his supervision.
- 3 Only nobles who enjoyed the complete confidence of the emperor were appointed to this office.



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

**CENTRAL ADMINISTRATION**

**CHIEF QAZI/SADR-US SUDUR**



- 1 The judicial department was headed by the *chief qazi*.
- 2 This post was sometimes combined with that of the *Sadr-us Sudur* (Chief Sadar) who was the head of the religious department.
- 3 His chief duty were:
  - to protect the laws of the Shariat
  - he was also responsible for all charitable and religious endowments.
- 4 Akbar's view was to prevail in case of conflicting views among religious scholars.



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

**CENTRAL ADMINISTRATION**

**CHIEF QAZI/SADR-US SUDUR**



- 5 Later, several restrictions were placed on the authority of the Sadar for award of revenue free grants also.
- 6 Two striking features of Inam grants were:
  - Akbar granted inam lands to all persons, irrespective of their religious faith and beliefs.
  - Akbar made it a rule that half of the inam land should consist of cultivable wasteland.

*Thus, the inam holders were encouraged to extend cultivation.*



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## CENTRAL ADMINISTRATION

### MUHTASIBS (CENSORS OF PUBLIC MORALS)



- 1 They were also appointed to ensure the general observance of the rules of morality.
- 2 He also used to examine weights and measures and enforce fair prices, etc.

#### NOTE

- The doors of the nobility were open to everyone, whether Turks, Afghans, Persians, Hindustani, or Shaikhzadas (Indian Muslims), or Hindu Rajputs.
- Due to extremely high salaries of Mughal nobles, there was a brain drain towards India as it attracted many talented persons from foreign lands to the Mughal court.



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## DECENTRALISATION IN ADMINISTRATION

The Mughal empire was divided into twelve subas or provinces by Akbar. These were

|   |           |    |        |    |        |    |        |
|---|-----------|----|--------|----|--------|----|--------|
| 1 | ALLAHABAD | 2  | AGRA   | 3  | AWADH  | 4  | AJMER  |
| 5 | AHMEDABAD | 6  | BIHAR  | 7  | BENGAL | 8  | DELHI  |
| 9 | KABUL     | 10 | LAHORE | 11 | MALWA  | 12 | MULTAN |



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## DECENTRALISATION IN ADMINISTRATION

THE EMPIRE WAS DIVIDED INTO





# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## DECENTRALISATION IN ADMINISTRATION

### NOTE

- The services of the **zamindars** were utilised for the maintenance of law and order in their areas as well as in the collection of revenue.
- The forts were placed under an officer called **Qiladar**. He was in charge of the general administration of the fort and the areas assigned in jagir to him.
- The port administration was independent of the provincial authority. The governor of the port was called **Mutasaddi** who was directly appointed by the Emperor.
- The Mutasaddi collected taxes on merchandise and maintained a customs house. He also supervised the mint house at the port.



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## LAND REVENUE ADMINISTRATION



- 1 The land revenue system adopted by Akbar was largely based on Sher Shah's system but with slight modifications and was called **Zabti or Bandobast system**, which was further improved by **Raja Todar Mal**.
- 2 Under this system, Todar Mal introduced a revamped and more detailed:
  - ✓ uniform system of land measurement
  - ✓ classification of land
  - ✓ fixation of rates
- 3 The revenue was one third of the average produce and was paid mostly in cash.



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## LAND REVENUE ADMINISTRATION

### DAHSA LA SYSTEM



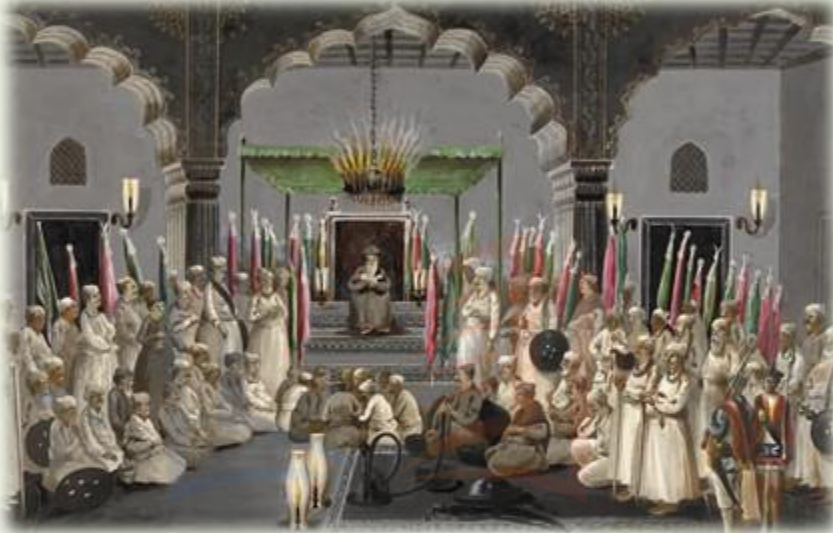
- 1** In 1580 AD, Akbar introduced the Dahsala System under which revenue was fixed on the average yield of land assessed on the basis of past ten years (dah years).
- 2** Later, a further improvement was made as not only local prices were taken into account, but parganas having the same type of productivity were grouped into separate assessment circles.



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## MAN SABDARI SYSTEM



**1** Akbar introduced the Mansabdari system in his administration.

**2** Under this system, every officer (Mansabdar) was assigned a rank (mansab).

**3** The lowest rank was 10 and The highest was 5,000 for the nobles.

**4** Princes of royal blood received even higher ranks.  
Eg : Raja Man Singh and Mirza Aziz Koka were honoured with the rank of 7,000 each.

**5** The mansab rank was not hereditary. All appointments and promotions as well as dismissals were directly made by the emperor.



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## MANSABDARI SYSTEM



**6** The ranks were further divided into two – **zat** and **sawar**.

**7** **Zat** means **personal** and apart from fixing the personal status of a person in the administration hierarchy, it also decided salary due to him.

**8** **Sawar** rank indicated the **number of cavalymen** (sawars) a person was required to maintain.

**9** Different terminologies were used for persons holding different ranks.

Eg.:

- persons holding **500 zat** were called **mansabdars**,
- those from **500 to 2500 Zat** were called **amirs**, and
- those holding ranks of **2500 Zats** and above were called **amir-i-umda** or **uma-i-azam**.



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## MAN SABDARI SYSTEM



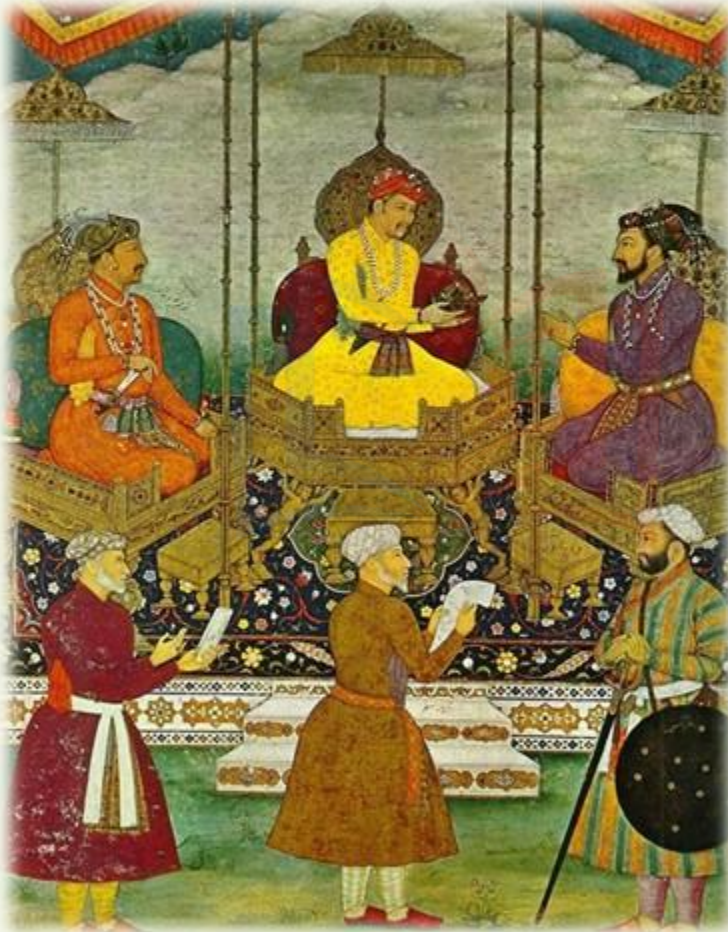
- 10** Periodic Inspection before persons appointed by the emperor
- 11** '10-20 RULE' was followed which meant that:
  - ✓ for every 10 cavalrymen –the Mansabdar had to maintain 20 horses.
- 12** The Mansabdar were paid handsomely. As a matter of fact, the Mughal Mansabdars formed the highest paid service in the world.



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## THE JAGIRDARI SYSTEM



- 1 Iqta of the Sultanate period in a modified form became Jagir under the Mughals.
- 2 The Jagirdari system, that is, the Mansabdari system. In case the payment was made through the assignment of a jagir, the office of the central Diwan would identify parganas the sum total of whose Jama was equal to the salary claim of the Mansabdars.
- 3 In case, the recorded Jama was in excess of salary claim the assignee was required to deposit the balance with the central treasury. On the other hand, if it was less than the salary claim the short fall was paid from the treasury.



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## THE JAGIRDARI SYSTEM



**4** There were various types of jagirs:

**1) TANKHA JAGIRS:**

- ✓ Which were given in lieu of salaries and they were transferable every three to four years.

**2) MASHRUT JAGIRS:**

- ✓ Which were given on certain conditions

**3) WATAN JAGIRS:**

- ✓ Which were assigned to zamindar or rajas in their local dominions. Watan Jagirs were hereditary and nontransferable.

**4) ALTAMGHA JAGIRS:**

- ✓ Which were given to Muslim nobles in their family towns or place of birth.



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## THE JAGIRDARI SYSTEM



- 5** Along with Jagirdars, there were zamindars who were the people who had hereditary rights over the produce of the land and claimed a direct share in the peasants produce which varied from 10% to 25% in different parts of the country.

- 6**
- Zamindars also assisted the state and the jagirdar in the collection of land revenue.
  - They had their own armed forces, and generally lived in forts, which was both a place of refuge and a status symbol.
- 7**
- It should be noted that the zamindar was not the 'owner' of all the lands comprising his zamindari.
  - The peasants who actually cultivated the land could not be dispossessed as long as they paid the land revenue.

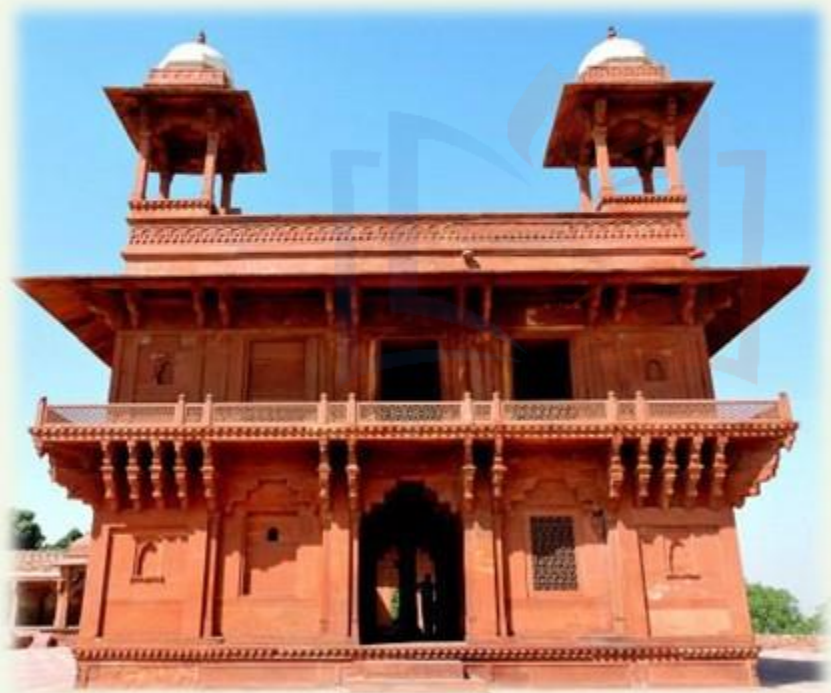
*Thus, the zamindars and the peasants had their own hereditary rights in land.*



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## AKBAR'S RELIGIOUS POLICY



- 1** In the beginning of his life, Akbar was a pious Muslim. He regularly visited the shrine of Sheikh Muinuddin Chisti at Ajmer. Later, he became a sceptical Muslim.
- 2** Akbar took various steps:
  - He abolished the pilgrim tax and in 1562 AD and also he abolished jiziya.
  - He allowed his Hindu wives to worship their own gods.
  - **IBADAT KHANA**
    - ✓ In 1575 , he constructed the Ibadat Khana (Hall of prayers) at his new capital Fatehpur Sikri wherein Akbar invited learned scholars from all religions like Hinduism, Jainism, Christianity, and Zoroastrianism and used to conduct religious discussions with them.



# MUGHAL DYNASTY

**AKBAR** (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

## AKBAR'S RELIGIOUS POLICY



- 3 He disliked the interference of the Muslim ulemas in political matters. In 1579 AD, he issued the "Infallibility Decree" by which he asserted his religious powers.
- 4 In 1582 AD, he promulgated a new religion called Din-i-Ilahi/Tauhindi-Ilahi (Divine Monotheism), which believes in one God and in Sul-i-Kul (peace to all).
- 5 It contained the good points of all religions and the basics were rational.
- 6 However, his new faith proved to be a failure. It fizzled out after his death. Even during his lifetime, it had only followers including Birbal, Abul Fazl, and Abul Faizi.



WE EXPRESS OUR  
SINCERE THANKS  
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by

---



Learning Space

**For Suggestions:**

[suggestions@learningspace.in](mailto:suggestions@learningspace.in)

**To Contact us:**

[info@learningspace.in](mailto:info@learningspace.in)

**For Information:**

[info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com](mailto:info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com)

**Visit us at:**

[www.learningspacedigital.com](http://www.learningspacedigital.com)

0866 244 44 72

98499 42299

94415 27588